

7_Descriptive

1 Counts

Table 1: Counts by Role and Treatment

	blind	nonblind	Sum
HR	71	66	137
Eng	80	74	154

Table 2: Counts by Versions

	blind	v1	v2	v3	v4	v5	v6	v7
HR	71	9	9	12	6	11	10	9
Eng	80	14	11	13	10	6	8	12

Table 3: Counts by Matched Pairs

Number of Pairs	
Complete_BH	5680
Realistic_BH	5254
Control	695

1.1 Distribution and Response Rate (Completed / Emailed)

```
## [1] "Number of Emails Addresses Survey was Distributed to (not counting bounced emails): 73555"
```

```
## [1] "Response Rate (%): 0.79"
```

2 Participant Demographics

2.1 Summary Table

Table 4: Participant Demographics

	HR	Eng
Panel A: Individual Characteristics		
Age	38.1	33.7
Gender: Female (%)	62.0	17.5
Gender: Male (%)	33.6	79.9
Gender: Non-binary / Other (%)	4.4	2.6
Race: White (%)	58.4	45.5
Race: Asian (%)	22.6	44.8
Race: Hispanic (%)	10.9	7.8
Race: Black (%)	5.1	1.3
Race: Other (%)	2.9	0.6
Edu: Have college degree (%)	92.7	96.1
Exp: No. Years at Current Firm	3.6	3.7
Exp: No. Years Recruiting	9.0	5.7
Exp: Interacted with UCB CS Student (%)	31.4	20.1
Panel B: Firm Characteristics		
Firm Size: Less than 100 (%)	27.0	47.4
Firm Size: 100 ~ 999 (%)	46.7	31.8
Firm Size: More than 1000 (%)	26.3	20.8
Firm Hiring Policy: Uses ATS (%)	21.2	25.3
Firm Hiring Policy: Blinds Race (%)	5.8	9.7
Firm Hiring Policy: Blinds Gender (%)	5.8	9.7
IRR: Firm Currently Hiring (%)	90.5	68.8
IRR: Wants to be Matched to UCB CS Candidate (%)	49.6	40.3

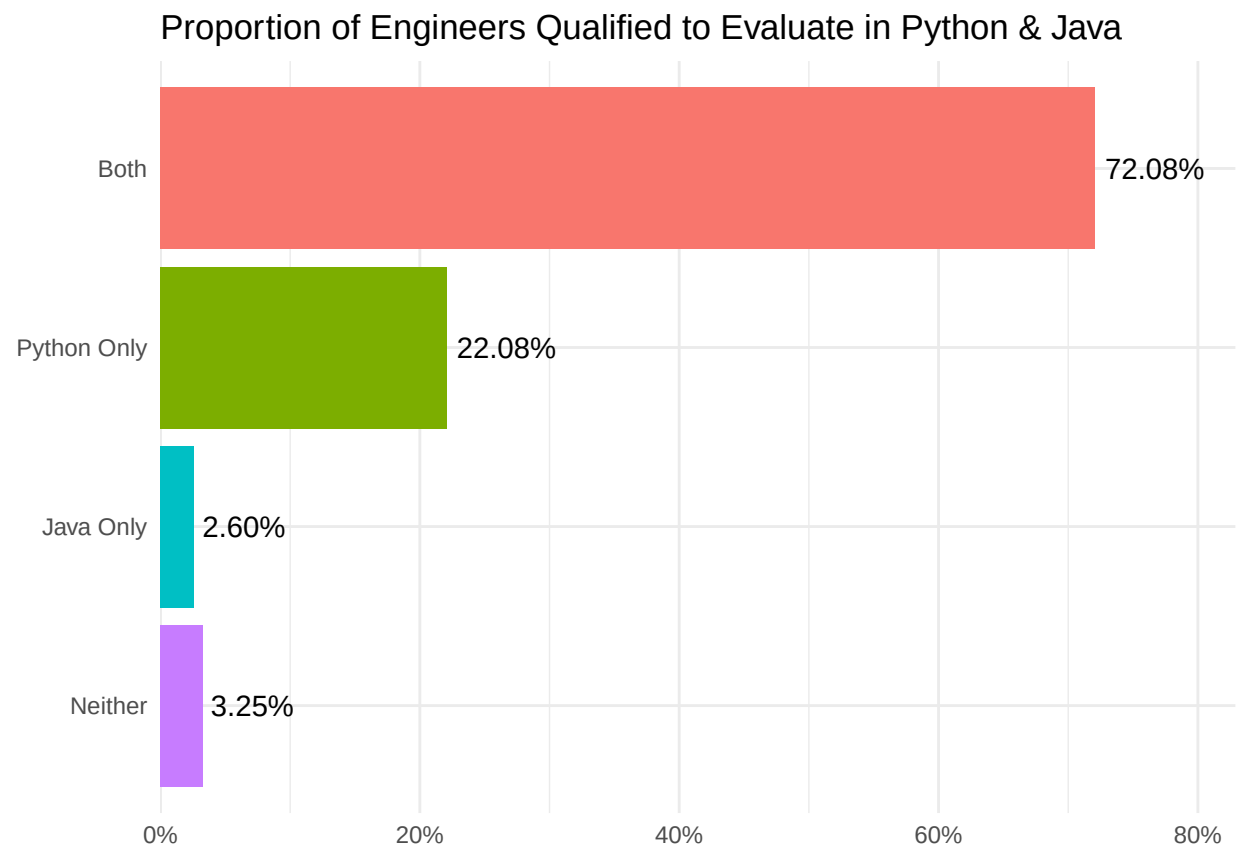
2.2 Primary Industry

Table 5: Industry Distribution (Self-Reported)

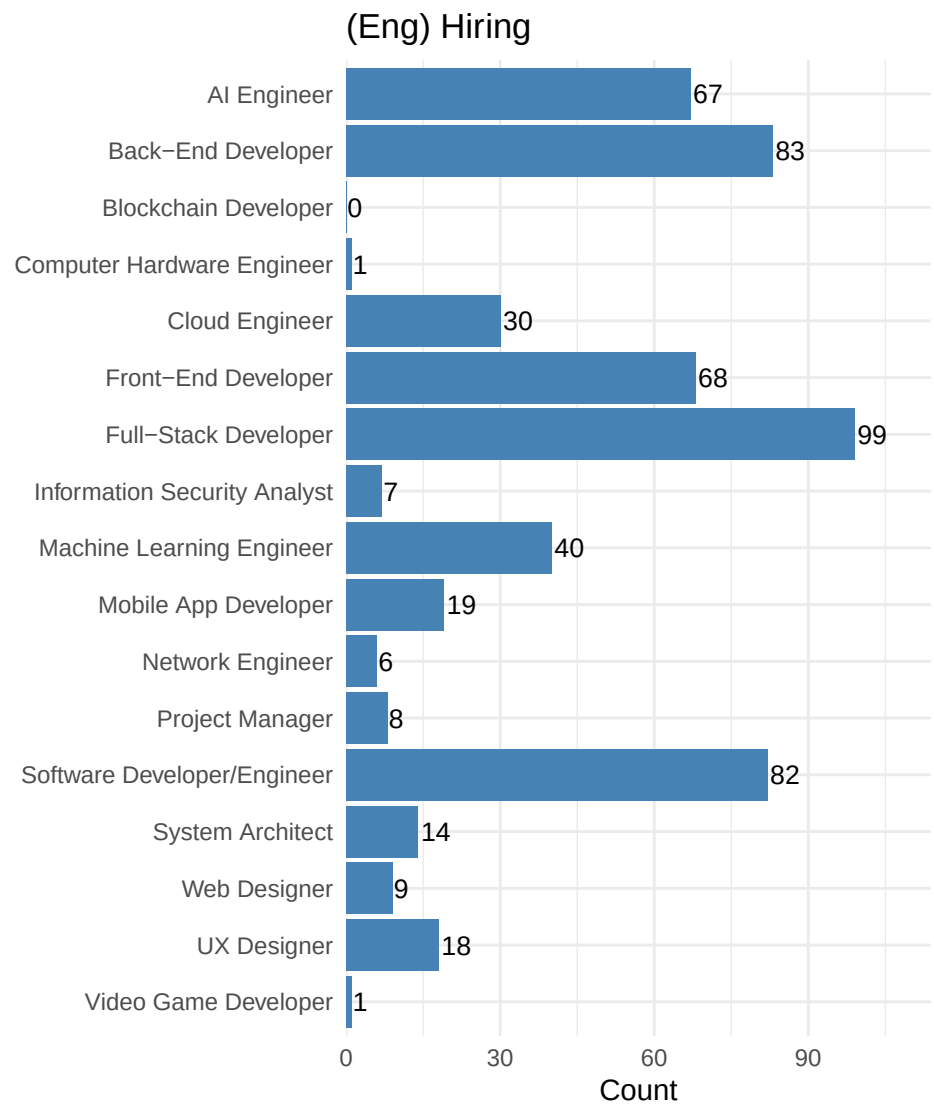
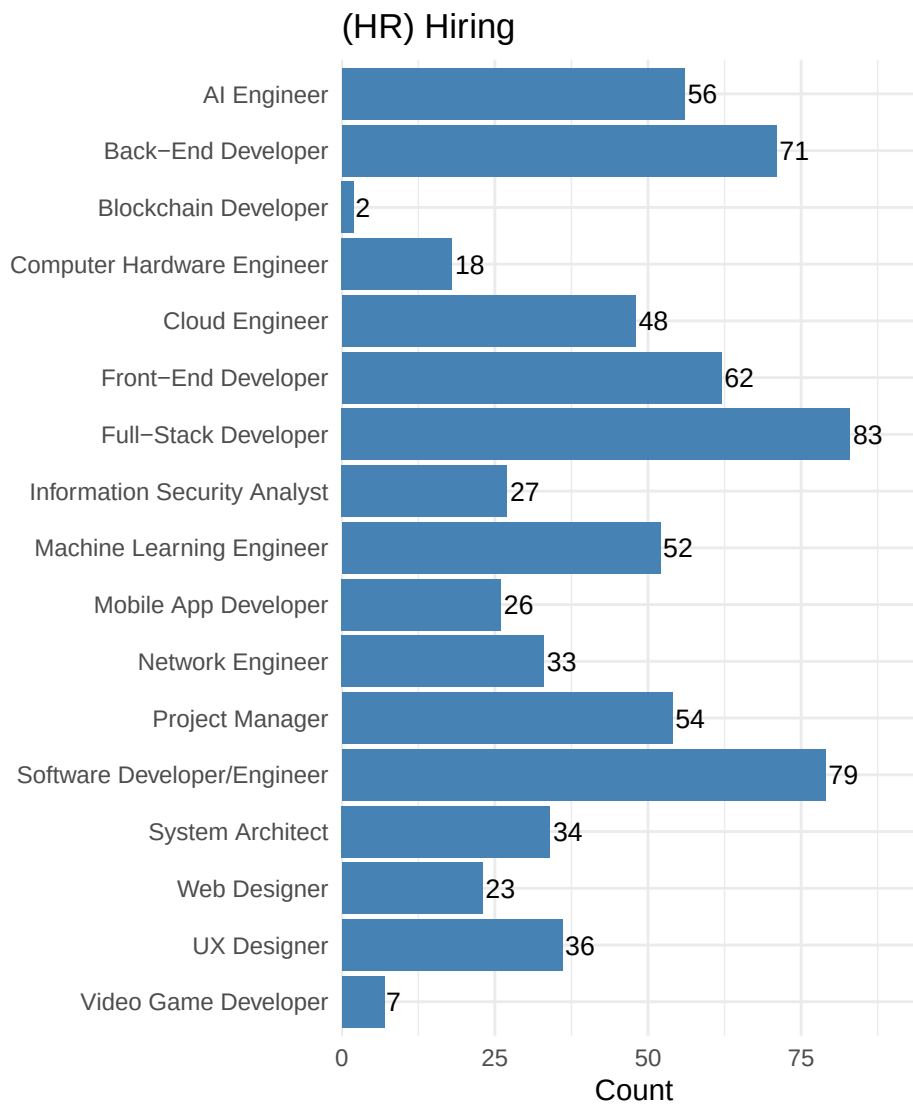
HR Professionals	N	Software Engineers	N
Information Technology/IT	30	Computer Software	63
Computer Software	29	Information Technology/IT	17
Human Resources	12	Healthcare	7
Telecommunications	9	Engineering	7
Engineering	7	Computer Hardware	5
Consulting	6	Consulting	5
Transportation	4	Energy/Utilities/Oil and Gas	4
Government/Public Sector	4	Automotive	4
Internet	4	Telecommunications	4
Healthcare	3	Government/Public Sector	4
Sales	3	Media/Entertainment	3
Automotive	3	Manufacturing	3
Advertising	2	Education	3
Security	2	Real Estate/Property	3
Consumer Electronics	2	Human Resources	2
Construction	1	Communications/Information	2
Real Estate/Property	1	Banking/Financial	2
Education	1	Advertising	2
Banking/Financial	1	Security	2
Bio-Tech	1	Market Research	1
Manufacturing	1	Construction	1
Accounting	1	Transportation	1
Media/Entertainment	1	Consumer Electronics	1
Legal/Law	1	Accounting	1
Marketing	1	Internet	1
Computer Hardware	1	Legal/Law	1
Other (write-in)	6	Marketing	1
	NA	Other (write-in)	4

2.3 Coding Lanugages (Python and Java)

Note: Of 18 candidates presented, 16 tested in Python, an 2 tested in Java



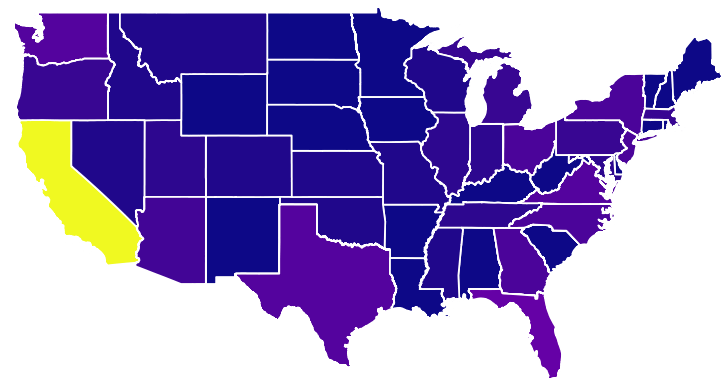
2.4 Position Hiring For



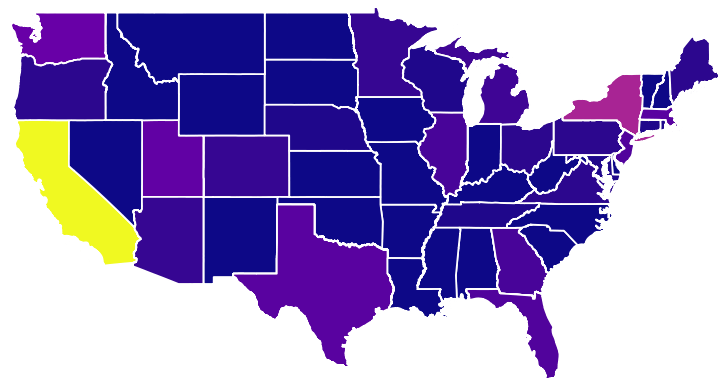
Respondent Residence Locations

HR

Engineers



Total N = 129 (Missing Zip = 5)



Total N = 147 (Missing Zip = 7)

3 Balance Check

3.1 Balance across Treatment (Nonblind vs Blind)

Within HR (Treatment Balance) - All

Table 6: HR: Respondent Demographics

	Age	Female	Male	White	Hispanic	Asian
Difference (Blind - Nonblind)	-0.259	-0.001	0.005	0.103	-0.052	-0.031
SE	(1.695)	(0.084)	(0.081)	(0.085)	(0.054)	(0.072)
Non-Blind Group Mean	38.273	0.621	0.333	0.530	0.136	0.242
N	137	137	137	137	137	137

Table 7: HR: Respondent Demographics 2

	< 50K	50-100K	100-150K	150-200K	200K+	University degree or more
Difference (Blind - Nonblind)	0.041	-0.096	0.169**	-0.015	-0.099	-0.024
SE	(0.031)	(0.080)	(0.076)	(0.070)	(0.063)	(0.045)
Non-Blind Group Mean	0.015	0.364	0.197	0.212	0.212	0.939
N	137	137	137	137	137	137

Table 8: HR: Firm Characteristics

	Size_Small	Size_Mid	Size_Large	Male %	Female %	White %	Hispanic %	Asian %
Difference (Blind - Nonblind)	0.083	-0.063	-0.019	-0.279	1.978	1.102	2.359	2.448
SE	(0.076)	(0.086)	(0.076)	(3.697)	(3.486)	(4.587)	(1.577)	(3.591)
Non-Blind Group Mean	0.227	0.500	0.273	54.913	41.071	46.227	7.795	18.712
N	137	137	137	137	137	137	137	137

Table 9: HR: Firm's DEI Policies

	Conducts BH	Non Discrimination Policy	Diveristy Policy	DEI Training	DEI Position	Tranparent Policy	Affinity Groups
Difference (Blind - Nonblind)	-0.065	0.010	0.032	0.043	0.061	0.011	-0.009
SE	(0.049)	(0.082)	(0.083)	(0.085)	(0.064)	(0.074)	(0.081)
Non-Blind Group Mean	0.121	0.652	0.348	0.394	0.136	0.242	0.333
N	137	137	137	137	137	137	137

Within Engineer (Treatment Balance) - All

Table 10: Engineers: Respondent Demographics

	Age	Female	Male	White	Hispanic	Asian
Difference (Blind - Nonblind)	-0.532	-0.027	0.055	0.095	-0.058	0.004
SE	(1.497)	(0.062)	(0.065)	(0.080)	(0.044)	(0.081)
Non-Blind Group Mean	33.932	0.189	0.770	0.405	0.108	0.446
N	154	154	154	154	154	154

Table 11: Engineers: Respondent Demographics 2

	< 50K	50-100K	100-150K	150-200K	200K+	University degree or more
Difference (Blind - Nonblind)	0.035	-0.088	-0.022	0.069	0.006	0.003
SE	(0.033)	(0.055)	(0.073)	(0.072)	(0.071)	(0.031)
Non-Blind Group Mean	0.027	0.176	0.297	0.243	0.257	0.959
N	154	154	154	154	154	154

Table 12: Engineers: Firm Characteristics

	Size_Small	Size_Mid	Size_Large	Male %	Female %	White %	Hispanic %	Asian %
Difference (Blind - Nonblind)	0.106	-0.116	0.010	-1.546	-0.291	-0.503	-2.962	-0.044
SE	(0.081)	(0.075)	(0.066)	(2.934)	(2.508)	(4.022)	(2.284)	(3.624)
Non-Blind Group Mean	0.419	0.378	0.203	68.285	30.215	51.808	10.442	24.326
N	154	154	154	154	154	154	154	154

Table 13: Engineers: Firm's DEI Policies

	Conducts BH	Non Discrimination Policy	Diveristy Policy	DEI Training	DEI Position	Tranparent Policy	Affinity Groups
Difference (Blind - Nonblind)	-0.061	0.050	-0.036	0.122*	0.029	0.027	0.062
SE	(0.052)	(0.081)	(0.074)	(0.071)	(0.053)	(0.058)	(0.065)
Non-Blind Group Mean	0.149	0.500	0.311	0.203	0.108	0.135	0.176
N	154	154	154	154	154	154	154

3.2 Balance across Versions

Version Balance within Nonblinded HR (All)

Table 14: HR Nonblind: Respondent Demographics

	v1 (N = 9)	v2 (N = 9)	v3 (N = 12)	v4 (N = 6)	v5 (N = 11)	v6 (N = 10)	v7 (N = 9)	p-value (joint test)
Age	36.778	39.111	42.167	34.167	31.091	40.700	42.556	0.149
Female	0.556	0.778	0.667	0.500	0.727	0.500	0.556	0.841
Male	0.333	0.222	0.333	0.500	0.182	0.500	0.333	0.750
White	0.444	0.556	0.333	0.667	0.727	0.600	0.444	0.598
Hispanic	0.222	0.111	0.083	0.333	0.091	0.000	0.222	0.542
Asian	0.222	0.333	0.333	0.000	0.182	0.300	0.222	0.792
< 50K	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.111	0.396
50-100K	0.222	0.333	0.333	0.667	0.545	0.200	0.333	0.444
100-150K	0.444	0.444	0.083	0.000	0.000	0.300	0.111	0.034**
150-200K	0.333	0.000	0.250	0.167	0.364	0.100	0.222	0.486
200K+	0.000	0.222	0.333	0.167	0.091	0.400	0.222	0.373
University degree or more	0.889	1.000	0.917	1.000	1.000	0.800	1.000	0.424

Table 15: HR Nonblind: Firm Characteristics

	v1 (N = 9)	v2 (N = 9)	v3 (N = 12)	v4 (N = 6)	v5 (N = 11)	v6 (N = 10)	v7 (N = 9)	p-value (joint test)
Size_Small	0.333	0.000	0.250	0.500	0.000	0.300	0.333	0.128
Size_Mid	0.556	0.889	0.333	0.333	0.455	0.500	0.444	0.267
Size_Large	0.111	0.111	0.417	0.167	0.545	0.200	0.222	0.212
Male %	57.222	51.667	63.583	57.833	43.299	61.800	48.889	0.392
Female %	42.111	36.667	36.417	40.333	47.428	37.600	47.222	0.820
White %	54.444	47.222	44.083	55.667	44.091	46.800	35.556	0.835
Hispanic %	7.500	7.778	8.083	5.167	7.000	10.000	8.000	0.963
Asian %	15.778	24.444	28.500	11.833	9.364	20.900	16.444	0.503

Table 16: HR Nonblind: Firm' Demographics's DEI Policies

	v1 (N = 9)	v2 (N = 9)	v3 (N = 12)	v4 (N = 6)	v5 (N = 11)	v6 (N = 10)	v7 (N = 9)	p-value (joint test)
Conducts BH	0.222	0.000	0.000	0.333	0.182	0.200	0.000	0.210
Non Discrimination Policy	0.889	0.889	0.500	0.500	0.455	0.700	0.667	0.226
Diveristy Policy	0.333	0.222	0.250	0.167	0.545	0.400	0.444	0.650
DEI Training	0.556	0.222	0.167	0.667	0.545	0.400	0.333	0.267
DEI Position	0.333	0.111	0.083	0.167	0.091	0.100	0.111	0.742
Tranparent Policy	0.222	0.111	0.167	0.333	0.455	0.200	0.222	0.659
Affinity Groups	0.333	0.444	0.333	0.167	0.455	0.200	0.333	0.855

Version Balance within Nonblinded Engineers (All)

Table 17: Eng Nonblind: Respondent Demographics

	v1 (N = 14)	v2 (N = 11)	v3 (N = 13)	v4 (N = 10)	v5 (N = 6)	v6 (N = 8)	v7 (N = 12)	p-value (joint test)
Age	31.786	41.182	32.923	36.400	37.667	27.625	31.167	0.051*
Female	0.143	0.182	0.154	0.200	0.167	0.250	0.250	0.993
Male	0.786	0.727	0.846	0.800	0.833	0.625	0.750	0.951
White	0.500	0.273	0.154	0.400	0.833	0.250	0.583	0.066*
Hispanic	0.143	0.182	0.154	0.200	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.553
Asian	0.286	0.455	0.615	0.400	0.167	0.750	0.417	0.248
< 50K	0.000	0.091	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.083	0.623
50-100K	0.214	0.364	0.077	0.200	0.000	0.125	0.167	0.544
100-150K	0.286	0.091	0.308	0.100	0.500	0.750	0.250	0.034**
150-200K	0.500	0.091	0.154	0.200	0.167	0.000	0.417	0.063*
200K+	0.000	0.364	0.462	0.500	0.333	0.125	0.083	0.022**
University degree or more	1.000	0.818	1.000	0.900	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.190

Table 18: Eng Nonblind: Firm Characteristics

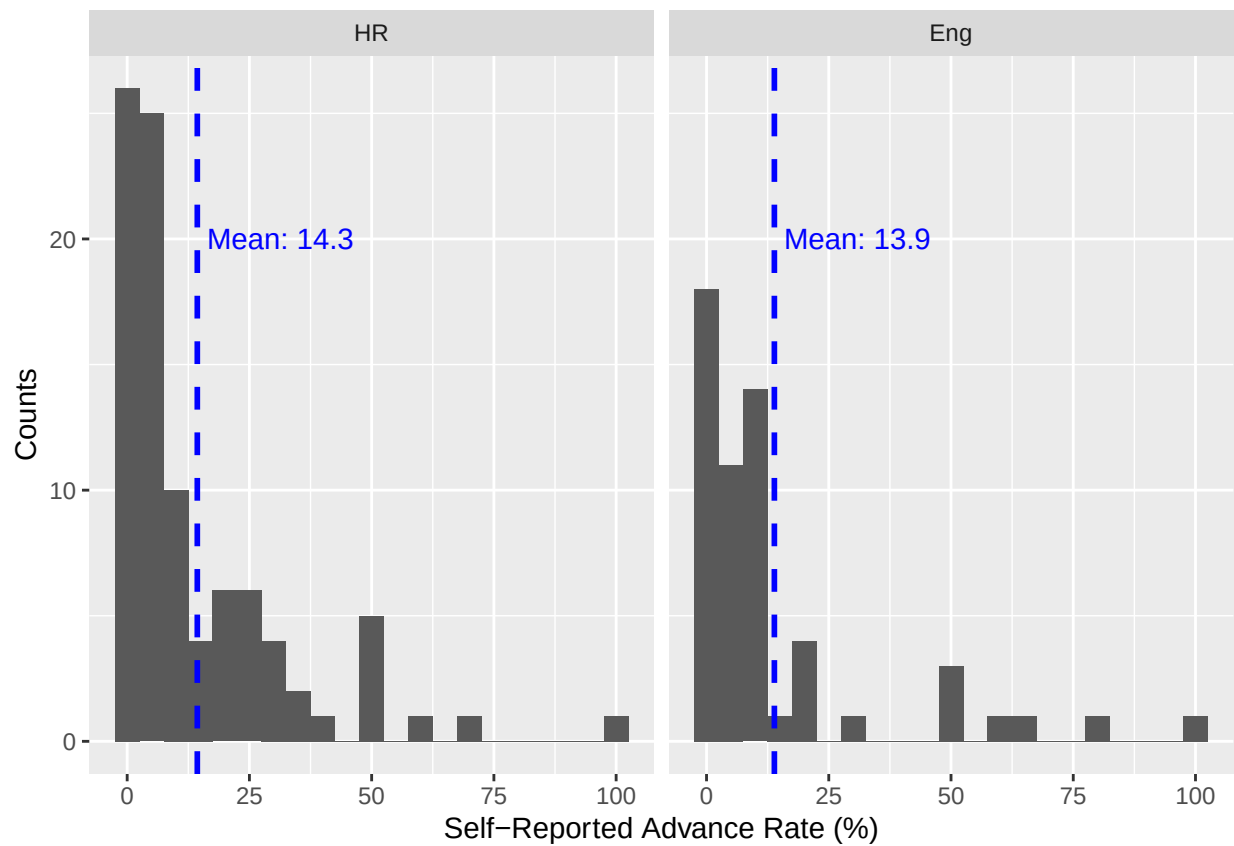
	v1 (N = 14)	v2 (N = 11)	v3 (N = 13)	v4 (N = 10)	v5 (N = 6)	v6 (N = 8)	v7 (N = 12)	p-value (joint test)
Size_Small	0.500	0.636	0.231	0.200	0.000	0.625	0.583	0.032**
Size_Mid	0.357	0.182	0.462	0.700	0.500	0.250	0.250	0.217
Size_Large	0.143	0.182	0.308	0.100	0.500	0.125	0.167	0.496
Male %	70.171	71.818	64.231	71.370	65.000	62.375	70.250	0.849
Female %	29.307	28.182	32.385	28.560	34.500	36.875	25.583	0.741
White %	50.500	50.636	47.615	43.480	50.000	58.750	62.167	0.624
Hispanic %	14.900	9.818	14.462	9.110	12.167	4.625	5.583	0.654
Asian %	25.221	29.091	27.308	23.200	25.833	16.250	21.250	0.884

Table 19: Eng Nonblind: Firm' Demographics's DEI Policies

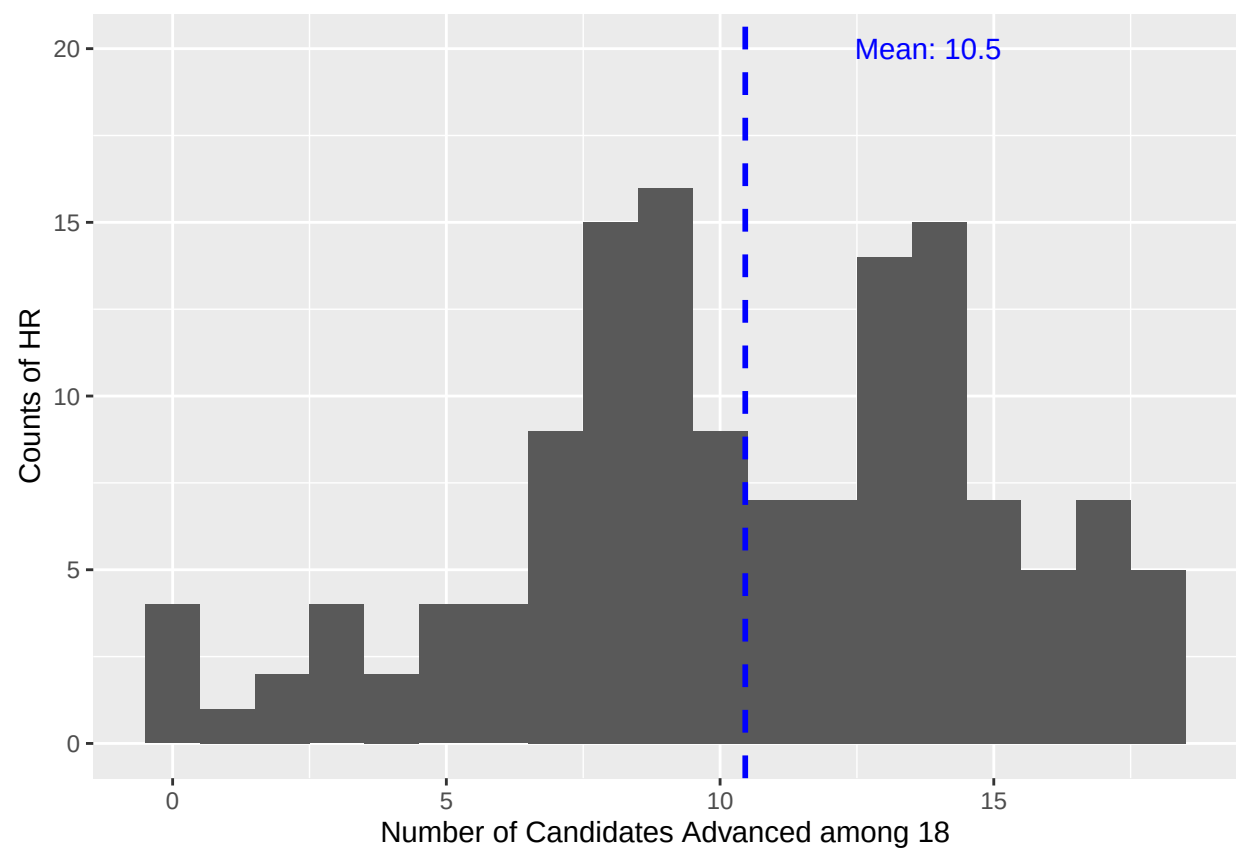
	v1 (N = 14)	v2 (N = 11)	v3 (N = 13)	v4 (N = 10)	v5 (N = 6)	v6 (N = 8)	v7 (N = 12)	p-value (joint test)
Conducts BH	0.143	0.000	0.308	0.100	0.000	0.375	0.083	0.154
Non Discrimination Policy	0.643	0.182	0.615	0.500	0.333	0.500	0.583	0.307
Diveristy Policy	0.643	0.000	0.308	0.400	0.167	0.250	0.250	0.031**
DEI Training	0.286	0.000	0.308	0.100	0.167	0.375	0.167	0.381
DEI Position	0.143	0.091	0.077	0.100	0.000	0.125	0.167	0.964
Tranparent Policy	0.214	0.091	0.077	0.100	0.167	0.000	0.250	0.690
Affinity Groups	0.143	0.091	0.231	0.200	0.167	0.250	0.167	0.977

4 [Explorations]

4.1 Proportion of Candidates Passed to Next Stage

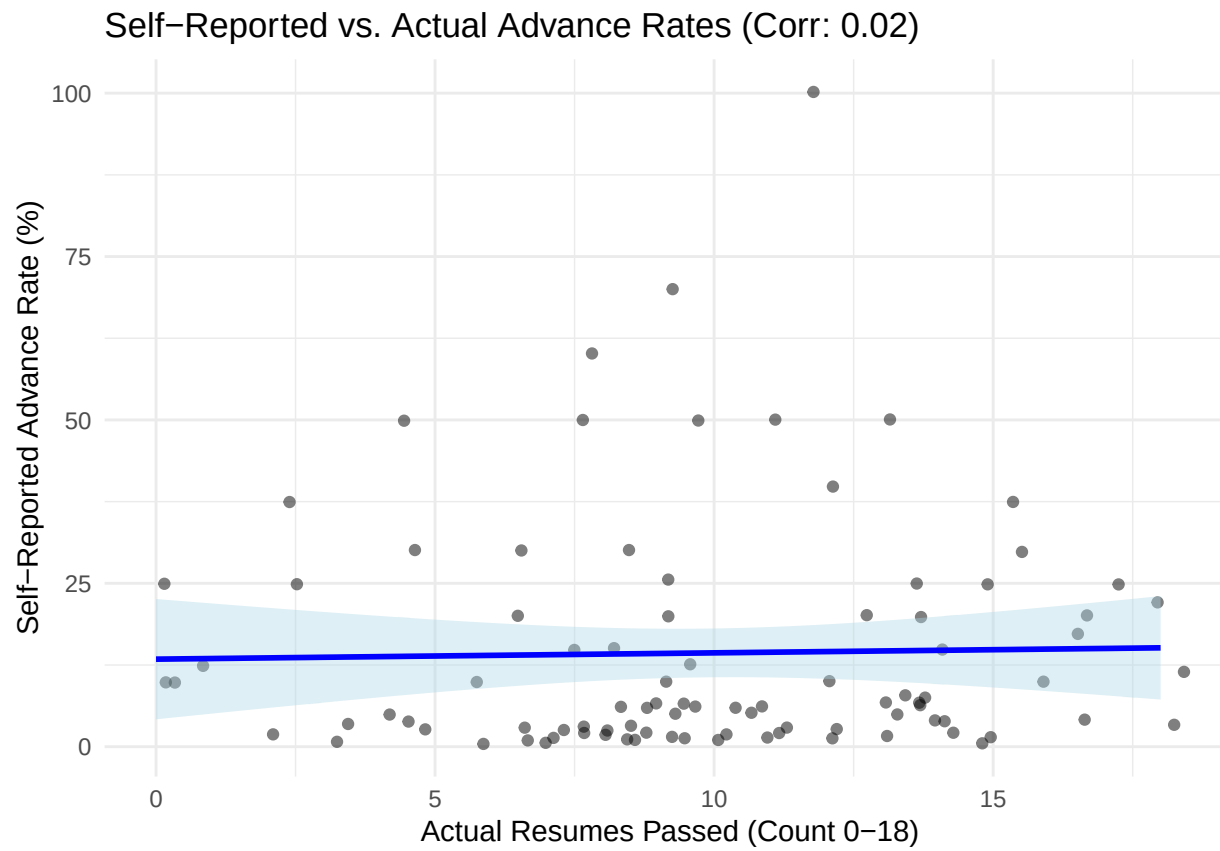


4.2 (HR) Number Candidates Passed to Next Stage

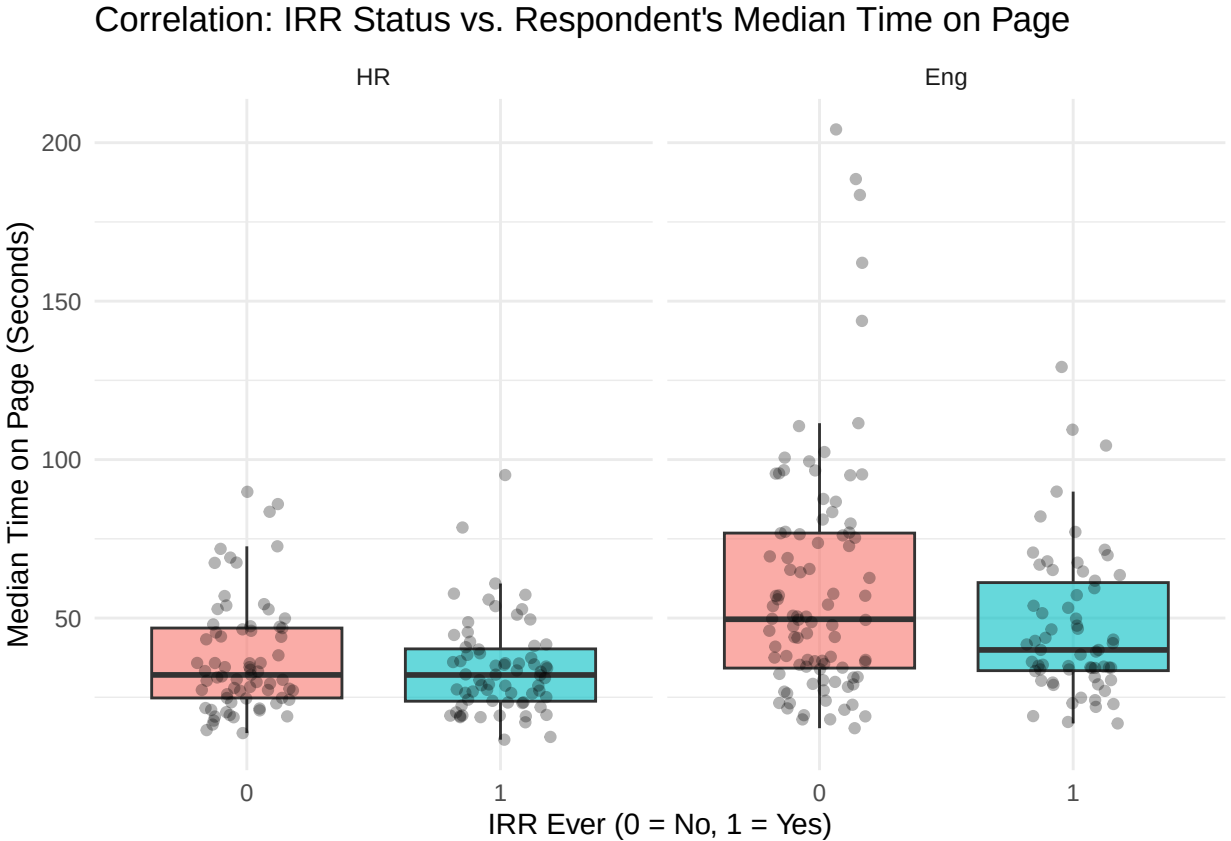


4.3 (HR) Correlation between Self Reported Advance Rate and Experimental Advance Rate

```
## 'geom_smooth()' using formula = 'y ~ x'
```

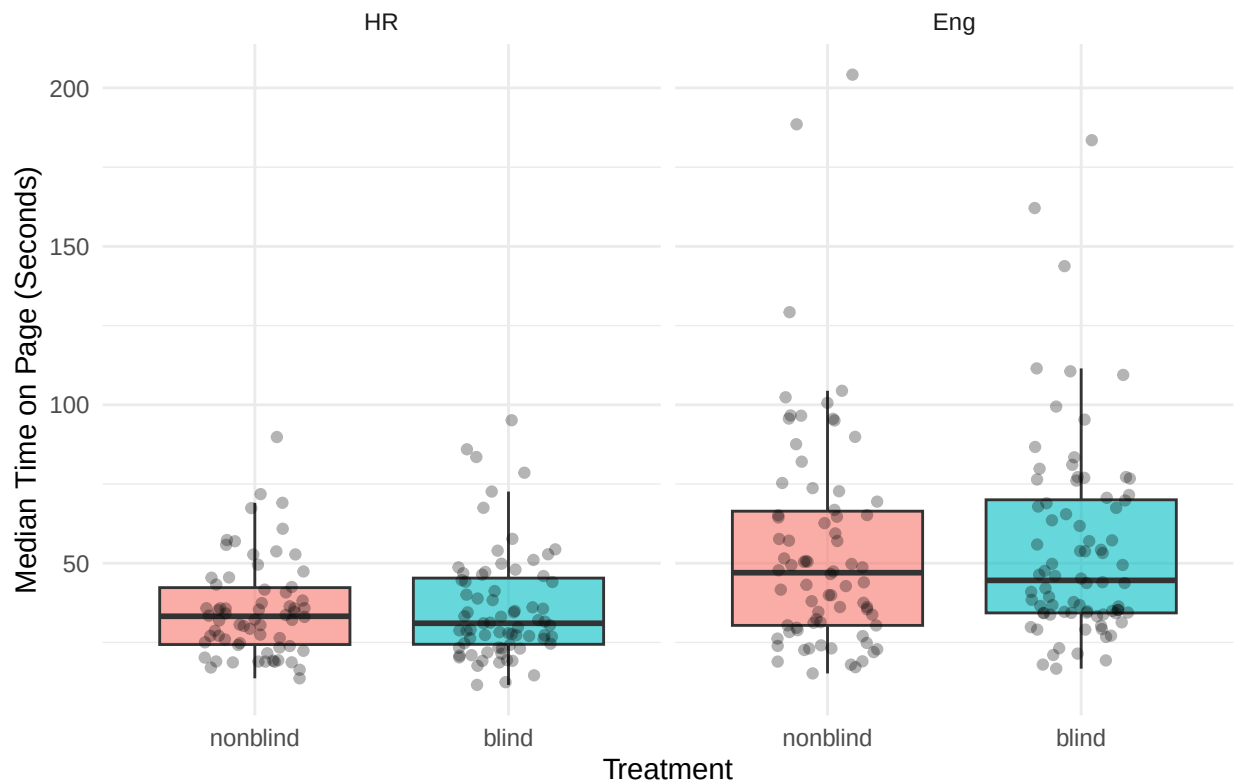


4.4 Correlation between IRR (want to receive resumes) and median time spent on resumes



4.5 Relationship between Time Spent on Evaluation by Treatment

Correlation: Treatment vs. Respondent's Median Time on Page



4.6 (Causal) Relationship between Time Spent On and Off the Evaluation by Treatment

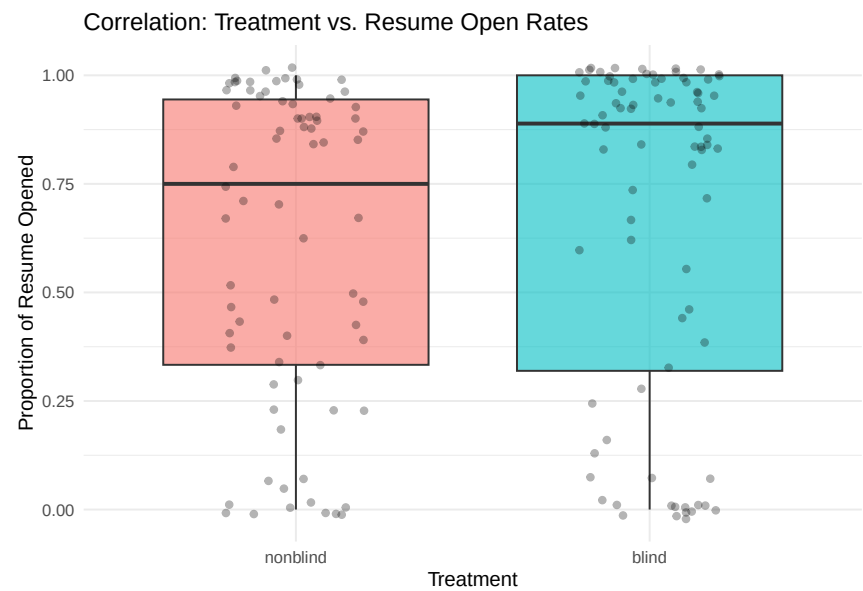
Effect of Treatment on Time Spent On Page (Fixed Effects)

	HR	Engineers
Blind Treatment	4.813 (4.610)	0.656 (6.400)
Num.Obs.	2466	2772
R2	0.065	0.202
R2 Adj.	0.048	0.190
FE: r_do	X	X
FE: resume_index	X	X
FE: resp_gender	X	X
FE: resp_race	X	X
FE: resp_python		X
FE: resp_java		X
* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01		

Effect of Treatment on Time Spent Off Page (Fixed Effects)

	HR	Engineers
Blind Treatment	10.056 (93.690)	-649.759 (666.964)
Num.Obs.	2466	2772
R2	0.015	0.056
R2 Adj.	-0.003	0.041
FE: r_do	X	X
FE: resume_index	X	X
FE: resp_gender	X	X
FE: resp_race	X	X
FE: resp_python		X
FE: resp_java		X
* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01		

4.7 (Eng Only) Relationship between Open Resume / Codes by Treatment



4.8 (Causal) Relationship between Open Resume / Codes by Treatment

Table 20: Effect of Treatment on Rate of Opening Res / Codes

	P(Open Res)	P(Open Code 1)	P(Open Code 2)
Blind Treatment	0.057 (0.060)	0.105* (0.060)	0.091 (0.062)
Num.Obs.	2772	2772	2772
R2	0.065	0.071	0.063
R2 Adj.	0.050	0.056	0.048
FE: r_do	X	X	X
FE: resume_index	X	X	X
FE: resp_gender	X	X	X
FE: resp_race	X	X	X
FE: resp_python	X	X	X
FE: resp_java	X	X	X

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$

4.9 Relationship between Blinding & IRR (want to receive resumes)

role	treat	Proportion	N
HR	blind	0.45	71
HR	nonblind	0.55	66
Eng	blind	0.42	80
Eng	nonblind	0.38	74

4.10 Relationship between Blinding & Looking at Outside Resources

role	treat	Proportion	N
HR	blind	0	71
HR	nonblind	0	66
Eng	blind	0	80
Eng	nonblind	0	74

5 Section 5: Thoughts on Blind Hirings (Collected for Last 2 weeks)

5.1 s5_insights_bh_chg (Blinded Group Only)

(Optional but encouraged) While evaluating candidates without names (or other information that could signal demographic background, such as home address or languages), how—if at all—did this affect the way you evaluated the candidates? What went through your mind?

(Please describe your thought process in your own words. There is no right or wrong answer.)

HR Responses

1. Demographic information doesn't matter unless screening candidates for onsite roles with restricted geographical location. For eg. if candidates are being shortlisted for in-person Hiring Event, address helps in weeding out non-locals.
2. did not affect at all
3. It forced me to focus specifically on their relevant experience and (likely) more accurately assess their capabilities and technical knowledge without any built-in bias.
4. It did not affect the way I reviewed the resume. I was going based of experience,, projects, and knowledge across programming skills.
5. I evaluate them the same way. I look at schooling, degree, and types of companies they worked at. When relevant, I look at duration at past companies, but with recent grads that doesnt really apply.
6. GPA, internships
7. I dont really stake out the name of the person when reviewing for the ability of the role. I have a few areas I scan before then that are a better tell for fit than the name. This review felt normal and I wasnt missing something I would get in a normal evaluation.
8. I was focused mostly on their technical skillset rather than trying to figure out their gender and ethnicity. I didn't realize that was the purpose of the exercise.
9. Never crossed my mind, I solely looked at experience
10. Not at all

Engineer Responses

1. Yes, socioeconomic background of a candidate gives good signal to their work ethic and personality.
2. I didn't pay attention to names.
3. For entry level, I pay most attention to how the candidate solved coding questions. The person's name, gender has no effect on my decision. Pedigree and GPA matters after the candidate has passed coding interviews.
4. The redaction of the candidates names did not impact my scoring system I used to evaluate. I evaluated their relative coding times, how well the code compiled, and leadership initiatives.

5. Did not affect me; I would not care about the name.
6. Did not affect at all. I didn't even realize the names were omitted.
7. When I evaluated candidates without names or demographic cues, I found that I focused much more on the substance of their experience and less on the narrative I might unconsciously build around them. Without signals like school, geography, or language, I relied more heavily on structured rubrics and specific evidence of skills and outcomes. It also made me more aware of how much those signals normally influence my perception. Overall, it encouraged slower, more deliberate evaluation and increased my confidence that I was shortlisting based primarily on capability rather than identity cues.
8. Nothing really changed. I assessed the resumes briefly, but more weight is put onto the coding portion. If the coding portion was not good, the candidate would not get an offer.
9. It did not even cross my mind. I only read their School, GPA, Projects, Work Experience
10. I actively distanced myself in attempt to objectively quantify each candidate based solely on their resume and coding solutions
11. It was nice to have "blinded" resumes to not introduce any bias.
12. For this particular assessment, I didn't look into the names or profiles of the individuals. I didn't review race, gender or anything else when looking at the candidates. When doing actual hiring, I will review the LinkedIn profile of all of the candidates, and confirm how they present themselves. I personally work for a non-biased approach based on hiring.
13. GPA / Education is meaningless. I've hired too many people right out of university, there's no correlation between technical skill and GPA. The name of the university is equally meaningless. Some of these resumes are clearly over-stating their importance. Some of the feats described in single bullet points would be among the highlights of a professional career, not something accomplished during an internship. It reduces my trust in the candidate. The actual code samples are more interesting. I gave more weight to those with readable code that made sense at a glance, even if it didn't compile or hit all of the test cases. At least one candidate included comments describing their thought process – that was very promising. Highly efficient code that I have to think about to understand is worthless in my field. Even if it works, it presents an ongoing technical burden to maintain. The code sample problems presented to the candidates to solve were not well designed as interview questions: I do not care if a candidate understands a specific algorithm because algorithms are always a single Google search away. I care about complexity management, clarity of thought, and readability/maintainability of the code. Asking better code questions of the candidates would have resulted in better evaluations of their abilities.
14. It didn't affect my process, since I normally only focus on their experience, their impact, and the performance of their technical evaluations.

5.2 s5_guess_gender and s5_guess_race

Thinking back on the candidates you evaluated, what do you believe was the approximate gender composition of the 18 candidates? Of race composition?

Table 21: Candidate Identity Guesses: Treatment Comparison with Sample Sizes

	Male	Female	Gender (Other)	White	Asian	Hispanic	Black	Race (Other)
Panel A: HR Professionals								
Blind (N = 13)	10.692	6.923	0.385	3.000	7.308	2.538	1.615	3.538
Non-blind (N = 13)	9.538	7.000	1.462	5.615	5.308	3.385	0.846	2.846
Difference (B - NB)	1.154	-0.077	-1.077	-2.615	2.000	-0.846	0.769	0.692
<i>P-value</i>	<i>0.277</i>	<i>0.931</i>	<i>0.455</i>	<i>0.047**</i>	<i>0.177</i>	<i>0.439</i>	<i>0.106</i>	<i>0.738</i>
Panel B: Software Engineers								
Blind (N = 23)	11.261	5.087	1.652	5.957	6.783	1.522	1.696	2.043
Non-blind (N = 17)	9.765	8.118	0.118	5.059	6.882	3.529	1.294	1.235
Difference (B - NB)	1.496	-3.031	1.535	0.898	-0.100	-2.008	0.402	0.808
<i>P-value</i>	<i>0.106</i>	<i>0.000***</i>	<i>0.080*</i>	<i>0.357</i>	<i>0.921</i>	<i>0.001***</i>	<i>0.297</i>	<i>0.459</i>

6 Qualitative Responses

6.1 s6_insight_hr

(Optional) Can you share any ways in which you felt engineers, who usually conduct technical interviews, pursued or not pursued DEI objectives in the hiring process and what impact it had on the firm, overall?

1. Looking more at technical abilities.
2. I do not feel it's necessary in the engineering field because it is dominated by minorities and non-white anyway.
3. Increasing representation through sourcing efforts, and being more patient to ensure URG are included in final round conversations.
4. While I feel DEI objectives are a worthy and important pursuit, my overall goal is to work with great candidates regardless of their gender and ethnicity. At Corvus, we want every single engineer we engage with to be successful and do everything we can to support them.
5. Our engineers are much more concerned with finding the best-qualified candidate. DEI is not a consideration at all.
6. I'm not sure if this is the right place to put this answer but it ultimately depends on if a candidate passes a technical. That's what we need, people passing technicals.
7. When I worked at a tech company (not Portola) to build out their first team in NYC, there was a big effort to focus recruiting engineers from diverse backgrounds. It slowed the hiring process and resulted in one very strong hire and one hire that wasn't as strong.
8. We don't focus much on DEI as we are always looking for the best candidate, no interest in gender or ethnicity/race.
9. Sometimes we work with DIE recruiting firms that focus on women, POC or non-binary recruiting.
10. My company does not put any focus on DEI. They focus on the strongest technical candidates.
11. We need to be focused on hiring and filling our roles. As a startup, we cannot be as focused on DEI measures as we are on filling roles.
12. It is not our focus, but we do our best to accommodate any individuals that might fall under diversity buckets.
13. First concern is always experience and performance. Sometimes not as willing to give someone a chance if they don't have the specific skills and experience.
14. We primarily hire based on merit (experience, technical skills and knowledge, potential, communication and collaboration abilities, etc.) When approaching hiring this way, while leveraging strategies to minimize opportunities for bias in the resume review, interview, and decision-making phases has led to our team hiring a great mix of diversity across culture, gender, etc.
15. We work with external clients to fill technical/engineering roles - some clients are highly motivated to ensure an equitable, diverse work environment, and it's not as much of a focus with some. Engineering, as it stands, can be very "boys' club", so it's always good to see when a hiring team ensures a diverse pool of talent.
16. Those who were more aware of the importance of DEI did have roles filled quicker, and longer placements of candidates on a team.
17. Currently my firm has really strong racial diversity but where it could get better is on the gender side. Specifically Engineering. We have female leaders across most orgs, and I like that a lot.
18. The team does want to be more diverse, however the tech stack we use is not that popular so it can be hard to find candidates in general.

19. I've been at lots of companies where there has been a push to hire for diversity but what ends up happening is the hires are one offs and can be made to feel like the token. Unfortunately, even for companies that want to hire for diversity or have valued it, the core driver behind the hiring process is familiarity with the technical stack and demonstrated proficiency. Any candidate that can get ace technical assessments will go far in interview process no matter what their background happens to be.
20. We just want the best talent no matter what
21. the company no longer mandates DEI so candidates are chosen based on skills and experience
22. To be perfectly honest, we don't care where you're from or how you identify. We want people who can do the job. Full stop.
23. We always try to ensure DEI objectives are considered with viewing resumes and selecting best candidates from blind tests of skills
24. There is a high focus on filling the business need and the technical skills to do so over any DEI objectives. the DEI things are just a bonus.
25. I'm not sure they have. Maybe pushing for more female
26. We support outside enterprise customers. Our initiatives have to align with the customer, so the initiatives are different with each role and can sometimes address DEI initiatives.
27. Engineers typically do not care about DEI objectives, as they want to work with smart people who share a passion for their work. In all my years of experience, I have found the only engineers to ask about DEI/diversity of the team are younger aged or new graduates who completed high school and their bachelor's degree in the United States.
28. Very rarely has DEI come into the conversation when deciding who to hire, they are going to select the stronger technical fit regardless of race, gender, diversity etc
29. It became a hiring obstacle, and companies has unrealitic expecations about the number of qualified DEI candidates.

6.2 s5_insight_engineer

(Optional) Can you share any ways in which you felt HR influenced or encouraged DEI objectives in the hiring process and what impact it had on the firm, overall?

1. We work with a meritocracy. It just so happens that this method obtains us an average racial makeup similar to a UC Berkeley CS Program.
2. HR Encourages lack of bias when screening and interviewing candidates, inclusive practices when conducting interviews.
3. In our case HR doesn't get involved in the hiring process.
4. No impact
5. I do not believe HR has really had an effect. Our VP of Engineering wants more women in the department
6. HR has been instrumental in embedding DEI principles throughout the hiring process, aligning with both organizational values and federal expectations for equitable workforce representation. They implemented structured interview frameworks, standardized evaluation rubrics, and required diverse hiring panels to reduce bias and ensure fair candidate assessment. In addition, HR partnered with outreach programs and minority-serving institutions to expand access to Health IT and STEM-related roles, helping attract candidates with varied professional and academic backgrounds. This not only strengthened compliance with federal diversity and equal opportunity goals but also brought in new perspectives that improved project outcomes. The impact was tangible teams became more collaborative, communication with diverse federal stakeholders improved, and innovation in health data systems benefited from a broader range of viewpoints. Over time, these efforts fostered a stronger sense of inclusion and mission alignment, reinforcing the company's credibility as a trusted and equitable healthit pioneer.
7. I've never had them influence the process for DEI
8. Haven't really seen any influence at all.
9. we look for Happy cheerful people who communicate well, this feedback from HR influences my mindset I guess.
10. I do not feel they have encouraged DEI objectives at all.
11. No; HR has not tried to influence us in any way
12. Founders are very open to people from diverse backgrounds.
13. Our company overall has no DEI objectives or DEI department. HR probably influences inadvertently through the resumes they pass to the development team.
14. I actually think that more of our DEI initiatives come from engineering - either when managers look at their teams and are like "oh no I lost all my women" or when individuals raise concerns about the makeup of certain teams. HR is generally supportive.
15. In general, HR could just bring more visibility via candidates that they outreach to, doesn't have to be explicit really.
16. When looking at two equally qualified candidates, we went with the more diverse one, partially influenced by HR/Executive directive. It has had no discernible positive/negative effect, and the hire has worked out great.
17. Not aware of anything they've done in this regard.
18. No explicit focus from HR on DEI in hiring.
19. Not at all, several years ago there was a brief mention, maybe HR filtered candidates a little. Most diversity, at least ethnically comes from contractors abroad for budget reasons rather than a desire for greater diversity. I've never heard discouragement or any sign of discrimination against a candidate on the basis of ethnicity or gender.

20. In general, we put more focus on technical competence than DEI
21. Our software engineering internship program is typically at least 40% female (not the case for the gender ratio in the rest of the engineering department)
22. We screen all resumes who fit the technical strengths, job location, and compensation range. Most of our projects are client focused and require onsite with clients to work and deliver. Right now we are trying to find people for Hawaii BCBS and it is a challenge to find right people to go there and work.
23. Your questions asking about the influence of HR vs engineering department is the wrong frame of mind. 1) These decisions are influenced more by individuals (executive leadership and hiring managers). 2) The fundamental role of HR is really to deal with non-technical matters. 3) Given the past few years, HR has increasingly become less important especially in non-big tech companies due to the rise of HR software solutions.
24. This is a firm that has no DEI bullshit.
25. Neither we pick the best candidate, race, gender, and age are irrelevant to a persons skills.
26. 1. Inclusive job descriptions and role requirements. HR can review job postings to: remove biased or gender-coded language; focus on must-have skills rather than inflated requirements; emphasize transferable skills and potential, not just pedigree; Impact: widens talent pool, attracts non-traditional or underrepresented candidates. 2. Diverse candidate sourcing strategies. HR can: partner with universities/associations serving underrepresented groups; use diverse job boards; encourage referrals beyond existing homogeneous networks; Impact: reduces copy-paste hiring where teams hire people similar to themselves. 3. Structured and standardized interviews. HR often: introduces structured interview rubrics; trains interviewers on avoiding unconscious bias; uses consistent scoring criteria across candidates; Impact: decisions become skills-based rather than culture fit based. 4. Diverse interview panels. HR may ensure: interviewers represent different genders, backgrounds, seniority levels; candidates see representation during the process; Impact: reduces single-perspective decision making and increases candidate comfort. 5. Use of data and DEI dashboards. HR can: track diversity metrics across candidate pipelines; analyze conversion stages where underrepresented candidates drop off; hold leaders accountable using measurable goals; Impact: shifts DEI from nice to have to measurable business objective. 6. Bias-awareness and inclusion training for hiring managers. HR can: conduct training around unconscious bias, microaggressions, and equitable hiring; coach leaders on inclusive decision making; Impact: creates systemic change rather than one-time initiatives.
27. This does not apply since we do not have any organizational DEI objectives
28. Our company had a lot of outreach towards underrepresented groups in colleges and organizations for hiring. This has led to more creative solutions, a better workplace environment, and more.
29. This has not happened in my experience at my company
30. I have felt that our HR department has very much tried to influence DEI within our organization, however, they don't push it beyond unnatural means
31. No. Doesn't really seem to come up much. Would hire more DEI if there were more candidates. The resumes that get to me are overwhelmingly male/hispanic because that's the demographics of the geographic region we hire from.

6.3 s5_insights_industry

(Optional) Do you have any additional thoughts on hiring trends or DEI initiatives? Feel free to share whatever you believe would be helpful for researchers.

1. Not at the moment.
2. I believe that diversity can be significantly shaped by a young grad's definition of their engineering identity. A grad who actively engages in diverse projects and pursues cross-industry internships demonstrates the versatility that hiring managers value. This proactive approach presents them as technically agnostic and open to exploring innovations for the purpose of innovation, a message that strongly resonates in today's dynamic landscape.
3. It is important to have a diverse workplace because through a diversity of ideas, opinions and approaches can we collectively thrive.
4. I think hiring someone BECAUSE they're in a protected category is a great way to end up with a less qualified candidate.
5. We try to be diverse but the amount of non-diverse candidates that apply is significantly higher than any women or minorities groups.
6. For myself and my firm, we hire the candidate most qualified for the role. I don't think we actively hire for diversity as a higher priority than hiring the best candidate for the job. Race, gender, equity, diversity, and inclusion should be supported and protected within employees. No one wants to be the diversity hire. No one wants to be the equity hire. Everyone wants to be hired as the best candidate for the job.
7. Studies show that bias (explicit and implicit) influences hiring and compensation; I think it's good to acknowledge this and take it into account during the hiring process, by blinding certain factors, and by weighting willingness to learn higher than prior experience.
8. Recent hiring trends show a shift toward skills-based recruitment, expanding access to diverse talent beyond traditional degree paths, while AI-driven tools are reshaping but also complicating fairness in hiring. In government contracting and Health IT, DEI initiatives are increasingly embedded in compliance frameworks and mission outcomes, emphasizing equitable outreach, accessibility, and inclusive hiring processes rather than strict diversity quotas. Organizations are prioritizing retention and inclusion alongside representation, recognizing that belonging and equitable advancement drive long-term workforce stability. At the same time, regulatory shifts and legal scrutiny have prompted some firms to scale back public DEI targets, focusing instead on internal accountability and transparent measurement of outcomes such as pay equity, engagement, and innovation. Overall, DEI is evolving from a standalone HR goal to an integrated business strategy that strengthens collaboration, innovation, and credibility in public-sector partnerships.
9. Making sure the hiring pipeline has a diversity of candidates
10. We look for the best person for the job based on timezone, location, etc.
11. honestly, I would be more concerned about technical ability
12. DEI is detrimental to hiring practices. Candidates should stand on their merit and abilities. DEI factors have zero impact on job ability. I think that the best candidate should get the job no matter race, gender, etc. The goal of a company is to produce the best product possible and make money and to do that they need to employ the best people that are available to them.
13. Just hire the best candidates
14. no clue
15. I can understand the intent, but I think it becomes poisonous pretty quickly
16. It was often a bigger initiative at previous jobs, but at my current job, our company is small and is already very diverse. So there has been no additional pressure to hire with diversity in mind, and we are trusted to hire the best candidates, regardless of their race, gender, etc.

17. Eliminating bias is a good thing.
18. There has been a definite shift away from DEI initiatives. It feels taboo to talk about/bring up with hiring managers and doesn't come up in conversation at all anymore.
19. i think it is negative, i have seen first hand hiring a minority over actual qualifications and it not working out
20. Some people believe that making DEI a priority in hiring casts a wider net, but in fact the opposite is true. Hiring strictly on merit casts the widest net.
21. As an Asian American woman, I love DEI initiatives. I would much rather work in a diverse environment. My current place of employment is very male and white dominant
22. I believe it helps find better candidates and removes systematic biases in hiring like, prestige or favoritism.
23. We should all strive towards a more diverse, equitable, and inclusive workplace. When running a business, that goal cannot compromise the quality bar for hiring. The best way to achieve both is by targeting top-of-funnel efforts and conducting more interviews.
24. I think it is good to have some DEI initiatives, but not if it slows the process or doesn't result in closing the strongest candidates.
25. For us, it is most important to hire a great candidate with strong skills.
26. We index on hiring the absolute best technical talent and if along the way these candidates are diverse, that is an added plus and we do what we can to boost their opportunities, but we do not use that as a criteria for assessment.
27. Our company has only ever had 2 new grad engineers. We're a small enough company that we're still trying to find product market fit, so it's sometimes hard for leadership to prioritize hiring a new grad rather than an experienced person. DEI hasn't ever been a strong movement in this company, but I've definitely been part of a company where it was a huge deal - a DEI department, yearly trainings, the whole shebang. We had an apprenticeship program (for folks with unusual backgrounds to get on-the-job training), and we had a recruiting program specifically for historically black colleges, and we hired from Grace Hopper. And we got some great engineers out of that! But even that org has let all the DEI staff go now. There's so much more focus on efficiency now, and those programs feel like remnants of a more idealistic era.
28. Priority should be on increasing the sources of candidates from diverse backgrounds, with a fair assessment of skills for the role. Increasing diversity just to check off a KPI does not set anyone up for success
29. We should just hire the best candidates, regardless of their race, gender, or sexual orientation. It's irrelevant to the position.
30. My view is that candidates should be evaluated on their skills, experience, and ability to contribute to the role, not on immutable characteristics such as gender or race. I also recognize that in some fields, natural hiring patterns may lead to homogeneity due to interest, applicant pools, or historical factors. Even so, I feel the most fair and consistent approach is to maintain uniform criteria for every candidate and focus on capability and performance. As an applicant myself, I would hope to be assessed under the same standards.
31. Our company is very positive for DEI and will stand for it. If the person is talented, we are open to give a second chance.
32. I think DEI has an overall negative effect on the hiring needs of an organization since it is reverse discrimination. It focuses on hiring based on race, ethnicity, and/or gender which actually goes against EEOC and other HR laws and policies. Hiring should be two-fold: 1) can this person do the job? (Are they qualified from a technical standpoint?) and 2) Are they a good culture fit? (Do they communicate well? Are they a good team player? Or, if the work is more independent, can they work independently?). DEI initiatives hurt organizations.
33. I believe the initiatives have good intentions, as long as it promotes fair hiring practices and inclusion.

34. I think it's always a balance, and we need to ensure we are doing our best to hire people who can do the job well, but it's good to be cognizant of social inequities and environments in which people can feel "minoritized"
35. Sourcing candidates from DEI initiatives is just as effective as sourcing from top tech schools.
36. I hesitated to say that DEI leads to hires of a better quality, especially when you're talking about pure technical ability. What I've found that DEI provides is a wider breadth of talent who have the same skill and potential, and a diversity-focused hiring team gives them a chance to apply and interview for a position they may not otherwise have been exposed to. While they may have the exact same technical knowledge as someone not in DEI-focused groups, the experience and soft skills they bring to the table can be invaluable in creating a welcoming, cohesive team environment.
37. DEI has declined in value under the current presidential administration, far less of a priority now.
38. DEI initiatives should start at the top of the funnel with the recruiting function creating a strategy that identifies groups focused on supporting and uplifting URM and Gender.
39. The challenge is more on hiring more senior engineers. If under represented groups are not getting their first job, they won't be senior engineers in a few years.
40. Ultimately, it's down to the founders to push for this. My firm works to place engineers at growing start ups and of the 10 companies we're working with, only one has been forthright in stating that they want to build gender and racial diversity for their engineering team. As a result, I've only sent over candidates who are either female or from under represented ethnic groups.
41. We just want the best talent no matter what
42. I do not believe DEI initiatives have much impact, especially today. There are many candidates that seem to have not only AI generated resumes but also use AI during the screening, even the technical interview. These candidates are often screened out, but not enough by HR. Additionally new positions in the next few months have been orientated toward entry-level roles because we realize they will use AI anyway, so we're looking for more flexible candidates than highly-skilled ones, at least in engineering specifically. These have come with hundreds of applications within days, so dealing with volume has been the biggest struggle, as well as domain technical knowledge, not coding specifically, but networking and AI usage.
43. I'm female, and I'm 100% certain I was hired in my previous position at Activision for that reason. I also feel pretty sure I've gotten interviews because I'm female and companies are trying to fill a quota. It's pretty obvious when the five candidates being interviewed for a highly desirable role are all female. My current company just plain doesn't care. We just want capable, responsible people.
44. I agree the DEI initiatives are important. However at start-ups, unfortunately, it is less prioritized during the hiring process – technical expertise and exact background and experience alignment are more valued. To answer the above question regarding the blind evaluation, lack of name or demographic background didn't make much difference.
45. I think it is an evolving practice that we can make better and needs to be better for the sake of better workplaces!
46. DEI is a collaborative effort, and all the members involved in hiring process should be educated/informed of organization's initiatives/policies/intent so unintentional bias doesn't happen at any point during the hiring process.
47. Names need not be aware while evaluating a resume.
48. It's a great thing, despite what the current administration is doing. This time will pass and the firms who remained aligned with their values (specifically DEI) will stand the test of time.
49. I have seen DEI being a nice to have thing, but at the end of the day filling the role with the person who can do the role is the most important thing. Sometimes those align and sometimes they do not.

50. I think they are important, and that some Engineers will specifically only engage with companies that do have those initiatives. In our case, since we work with federal clients, we are unfortunately restricted to only being able to hire Green Card holders and US Citizens, which minimizes our ability to hire more diverse talent,
51. If your team is grossly not representative, that's a clear issue because I believe its important to have a diverse set of perspectives to create a good product. At the same time, hiring needs to be done, and people who clear a high bar are few and far between, so you need to hire them when you can, even if it doesn't fit your perfect "diverse standard". To me, this means actively searching for candidates that would lead to a more diverse team and workforce, while not compromising on candidate quality.
52. I felt this exercise was not at all how we evaluate candidates. A candidate's GPA doesn't matter. Their previous experience also doesn't matter that much. They're all at UC Berkeley. The only positive signal I care about is a previous internship at a tech company with a high bar (such as the Uber candidates, but startup experience is even better). I don't look at the projects. Everyone can do projects. We also do not ask these abstract "leetcode" questions. We ask our interns to implement solutions to practical business problems. So I also don't really care about the LeetCode section. The two example coding questions are exactly the kind of coding question we hate asking. All in all, if it feels my scores are arbitrary, it's because the evaluation process in this survey is highly flawed. Maybe it is representative of how large companies hire, but it is very far from how startups are hiring candidates these days.
53. It's BS.
54. DEI initiatives that promote equity by creating opportunities for historically underrepresented groups are important in the STEM field to ensure that technological progress is inclusive, representative, and socially responsible.
55. DEI initiatives are incredibly important; however, I have seen the lesser talent selected just to meet a DEI initiative. This hurts company growth and creates ill will. At the end of the day, the best talent/ culture fit should be selected.
56. Put more resources into getting underrepresented groups trained starting in high school and college. Trying to force diversity quotas do not promote a more diverse workforce across the industry, as you need to increase the number of diverse participants in the labor market if you would like to see a more diverse workforce.
57. It used to be a big deal in the US, now with the new political climate, I feel the DEI movement is dead. Ultimately, I feel it will come back, but not as strong at it used to be. Outside of political trends, I feel diversity is important in tech, especially as we are crafting the next wave of tech with AI, you want all voices for be represented in it.
58. I think it is a good thing to be aware of and keep in mind if possible but ultimately the skillset is the most important factor
59. Government integrator or companies that are reliant on the administration do not publicize DEI initiatives currently because it may affect ability to win work or economically advance.
60. So glad that DEI is on the way, just hire the past candidates, we need to leave discrimination in hiring in the past where it belongs.
61. "Skills-based hiring replacing pedigree-based hiring". Organizations are increasingly: de-emphasizing specific universities or employers; valuing portfolios, certifications, and demonstrated skills using structured assessments over informal fit conversations. Why it matters for DEI: This reduces systemic barriers for candidates without elite institutional access and diversifies socioeconomic backgrounds in hiring. 2. Focus on accessibility and disability inclusion. Hiring processes are being redesigned to support: neurodiversity-friendly interviews; flexible work arrangements; accessible ATS platforms and testing environments; Trend: disability inclusion is shifting from compliance capability enablement. 3. Remote and hybrid work expanding geographic diversity. Remote models allow firms to: hire outside major urban centers; tap global or rural talent pools; support caregivers and those with mobility constraints; Impact: greater diversity across age, caregiving status, and geography. 4. Data-driven accountability replacing purely narrative DEI commitments. Organizations are: tracking representation across funnel stages; reviewing promotion velocity by demographic groups; linking leadership incentives to DEI progress; Shift: DEI becoming operational, not symbolic. "DEI initiatives gaining traction" 1. Inclusion moving beyond hiring to belonging. Firms are recognizing that: hiring diverse talent without inclusion leads to attrition; psychological safety and sponsorship programs matter; ERGs are evolving into policy-shaping stakeholders. 2. Focus on

intersectionality. Beyond single-axis diversity metrics, companies are beginning to look at: race gender disability caregiving status; disparity of experience across overlapping identities. 3. Transparency expectations from candidates. Candidates increasingly expect: published pay bands; demographic transparency reports; visible commitments backed by action, not marketing.

62. When evaluating a candidate I always look for high integrity and character and somewhat proficient. We can teach monkey skills to anyone but you can't teach someone good work ethic. Everyone wants the high trust and high performance person but I would rather higher someone who I have high trust that is somewhat proficient rather than someone who is extremely proficient but does not have integrity and character.
63. Regarding hiring trends within my company, I have noticed a significant emphasis on communication and behavioral skills. I often see junior candidates focus too heavily on the technical portion, treating the behavioral interview as merely a means to an end. They tend to rush through it to reach the coding section, but this is a mistake. Communication is measured in every part of the interview. We evaluate it when candidates piece together a narrative for behavioral questions and when they form a logical train of thought during technical problems. If a candidate struggles to give clear answers or fails to expand on their reasoning, it hurts their evaluation regardless of their code quality. Some of the best candidates I have interviewed stood out because they were easy to communicate with. The interview felt like a natural back and forth conversation with a colleague I already knew rather than an awkward first meeting. While technical skills are essential, they are only half of what we evaluate. Coding can be taught, but communication is a much harder skill to develop. This is especially true for senior positions where technical proficiency is just a baseline requirement, but even juniors need to practice this to avoid falling flat. Another trend involves the nuance of AI. Our company does not allow candidates to use AI during the interview, but we fully expect them to embrace it once hired. Candidates should become familiar with AI tooling like Cursor, Claude Code, or Windsurf and use them to their advantage in their daily work. However, they must strike a difficult balance. Because the interview process is strictly no AI, candidates cannot rely on these tools entirely or they risk appearing clueless without them. They must maintain deep fundamental knowledge to pass the interview while demonstrating the adaptability to use AI tools effectively on the job. Finally, I am seeing a trend toward increasing specialization in job postings. The concept of the generalist developer is becoming less valuable compared to candidates with specific domain experience. To make their resumes stand out, candidates should build strong foundational coding skills but focus on specializing in a particular domain.
64. With the new presidency, the current economic situation, and layoffs in tech, I have noticed that more new hires tend to skew white and male. This was not the case a few years ago. I have also seen in our demographic reports that minorities are making up less of a percentage of the workforce.
65. In the five years I've held tenure at my company, I've spearheaded the discussion on building an equitable workplace. I explicitly have told my CEO and CTO that we must actively implement an affirmative action policy to ensure we hire more women and POC- we need to be the change we want to see in the world. Sadly it's been an uphill battle. Partially on the part of my company being based in Portland, OR, the whitest city in America. We rely on referrals to an extent, and that results in a same-ness among our candidacy- a lot of well qualified white men. The hostile political landscape and certain newer additions to the company have curtailed my ability to lobby for DEI and affirmative action policies. It's a large part of why I'm in the middle of a departure process. I want to thank you for asking these questions- they are vitally important to me.
66. You can't hire a diverse workforce if there aren't candidates from diverse backgrounds. Having diverse candidates starts much earlier than posting job availability. as a society we should ensure that all children know that they can pursue any career that they're interested in, and we should not steer children away from things because they don't "fit" in a certain career.
67. seem to be less prevalent now than in years past
68. While DEI initiatives can create a fairer, more innovative workplace within the existing system, they are ultimately limited by the very nature of capitalism. Collective solutions like unionization address the foundational imbalance between workers and bosses that DEI cannot resolve.
69. My tech candidates are mostly Asian (east and south), make and F1 visa holders. I don't think UC Berkeley fresh grads in CS are interested in early/pre-revenue startups.
70. I feel I look for the best candidate to fill a role, regardless of race or gender. However, I have seen firsthand how networking influences who is attracted. So the sooner an organization encourages DEI hires, the sooner the organization naturally has a more diverse workfoce.

71. You might notice the salary range we expect to offer is not in line with what a US candidate might expect. We *are* hiring in the US, but, not much. I'd say 90% of the hires end up being overseas, where the salary range makes more sense.

6.4 s6_feedback

(Optional) Do you have any suggestions for improving this survey?

1. I think how long a candidate will stay is a useless question for entry level positions
2. no it was great! loved the info check after one resume to show we are thoughtfully reviewing
3. it took so much longer than the estimated 15 minutes. I almost quit. there is no reason to make people evaluate that many resumes and code tests. it was absurd.
4. Maybe a section that allows the surveyor to explain the reason for the ratings. Evaluations of resumes don't always skew so black/white.
5. Several of the coding questions, especially on the second question, had odd syntax and variable naming. It seemed like the students were asked a slight variation of the question (which is fine) but mixed the island count function naming with crop/plots/farming naming. Number of islands is a very common leetcode question, and while students should be expected to identify the BFS pattern there's extra difficulty being asked a variant compared to being presented the standard number of islands question other students have likely seen verbatim previously.
6. Quiz on the resumes to check attention on the survey does not work, since I absolutely do not look at GPA, nor work experience, simply tech stack and capabilities with it.
7. It's impossible to gauge whether a candidate qualifies for a position without a position description. Please include one in the next version of this survey. Additionally, there is no way to know if the candidate will "fit" into a company without an interview. "Fit" is determined by far more than just certifications and experience. Neither can I predict if any given candidate will stay at the company for five years. That's impossible to predict. Does the new employee get hit by a bus, decide to move to another city for love, or get a better offer to develop the next big widget that will revolutionize the world as we know it? Who can say?! It's an impossible question to answer from a resume.
8. Asking the question about GPA details midway through code evaluation was sneaky. I made sure to pay better attention to that section of the remaining resumes, however you should know that entire section really gears you toward the code review portion, making it easy to skip past the small chunk of listed experience
9. Yes, there are more than resume and code. There should be an option to rank or mark code readability or code accessibility. In normal work conditions, there are comments, coding patterns, etc. that are more important than code just running and passing test cases
10. No, I thought it was a good amount of time and effort
11. The attention check question appeared rather early in the survey. I assumed once I read the resume and filled out the interview that I had to reset for the next candidate to be as fair and unbiased as possible. After the attention check, I was trying to memorize the resumes more and felt like that was introducing more bias since the details of each candidate lasted longer in my head.
12. I'm interested to see the results.
13. Be more honest about the length of time this will take
14. one of the questioned how many people we gave a technical interview to but i didn't know timeframe. A year? A month?
15. My only advice is for the candidates. Applying for jobs is a multi-step filtering process. Nobody will see your resume if you don't pass the coding tests. If you fail even a single case your code won't even be reviewed to see if you were close. If you pass but never get at least a phone screen it's HR tossing your resume. If HR approves it'll go to an engineering manager. If eng manager approves you'll schedule interviews and actual engineers conducting the interviews will get your info a day or two early, but most won't look at resume until a few minutes before. If you're not getting to interviews with engineers you're being rejected

by HR/managers. If you've got extra time, cleaning up your code & making it readable/efficient can help at smaller companies where people will actually look at it. When I worked at Amazon I never saw anybody's code from the initial tests so just pass the tests there and leave the code ugly. Most time I've spent reviewing resumes before interviews is ~10 minutes. My order of operations is GPA just to make sure it's not super low but I'm sure HR filters this before me, then recent companies + time spent at each. Then I'll look at skills list to make sure stuff we use (Python, JavaScript for example) is listed, then I'll go back and skim detailed bullet points looking for Python/JavaScript ones if I can. What I mainly want to see from bullet points is initiative, some kind of project/work that wasn't just "doing your job". All the resumes I saw in the survey looked good enough, so I mainly judged things on the coding challenge and tried to get a picture of the candidate from the code they wrote since all my interviewing is more technical in nature and the resume is for HR to look at

16. The biggest thing about the coding examples is not including any code comments about the thought process around what they are trying to solve and why they went about it one way or another. Those that included it I scored higher.
17. Not really
18. Scroll instead of "show more" buttons
19. I reviewed the resumes like I do at my actual job. I skip a lot of what I consider noise, and thus the question about "select two job experiences" completely caught me off guard. It would have been nice to know ahead of time that you expected that level of inspection.
20. Less applicants. After awhile, they all blur together and your answers become less accurate. In a real hiring situation, I would not review 18+ resumes, we would either split them up among reviewers, or our recruiter would filter it down before passing them to us. Also, with these types of entry-level, limited experience, applicants, it's impossible to tell "how likely would they stay for 5 years", without talking to them.
21. Clarify what sort of role I'm evaluating these candidates for, and if I'm evaluating them for my company or in general. Instead of a 0 to 100 rating I suggest 1 to 4, this is what most ATS have as options (1 is Definitely do not move forward, 4 is Definitely move forward).
22. Maybe a CV question with blinded out names and universities to help asses bias..?
23. The font overall is too light colored and it an eye strain. The font on the resumes made it hard to read, choose a more neutral font.
24. It would've been nice to be able to go back to the original prompt before seeing any resumes. The phrasing of the per-candidate questions was ambiguous to me. Was I meant to be using their resume to predict their coding exercise performance? Or was I meant to be using all 3 inputs (resume + 2 coding solutions) to make a judgement call on how their coding would be at my firm. My instinct coming in was that it would be structured as the former, but I filled out the survey according to the latter because that felt more logical. I had no way of going back to confirm though.
25. we evaluate resumes based on a job description. You cannot really evaluate a resume blindly for "any role" at the company. Level, role, responsibilities- all of these things are critical in the evaluation.
26. I might add a role or drop down question per resume - so for example if it's a more frontend eng related resume, you might ask how likely will I consider this resume for that role vs. a fullstack role. Or a ML profile with a role that is for a MLE or ML Researcher - the resume might be good for one but not both of those roles.
27. I was asked if I had googled anyone in the survey, but my survey was blind - I didn't have any names! Also, my survey timed out before I could complete it and it caused an error when I tried to submit. I definitely spent about an hour on it, not 20 mins!
28. Not sure on the "overall rating" and moving forward. Is it overall even if they aren't a fit for any type of role I would hire? Same with moving forward. I answered assuming it was just, an engineer in general, but clarity would be important considering you had a question regarding "fit" at the company.
29. Shorten the length
30. Somehow make it move obvious that you can expand resumes (or other sections). I didn't realize this at first

31. I understand the need for testing if people are actually reading the resumes, but I often just don't care about things like GPA or the names of previous employers. I'm scanning the content of their work, project descriptions, technology familiarity, and code test results. So I may have gotten some answers wrong during your mid-survey test to see if I'm paying attention, but I still stand by that it accurately reflects my hiring approach, and I think you should consider this.
32. It's hard to answer some of the questions because it's very dependent on the type of role I'm hiring for. Very few candidates would be right for my specific roles right now, but I still think they could be a fit for different roles within SWE. I mainly hire MS and PhDs right now
33. I didn't notice the scale was 1-100. I put 5 to represent the midpoint. It is nearly impossible to quantify how long we think someone will stay at our company as well. That's a tricky question.
34. Some of the questions are very subjective so I do not think its fair to rank candidates on a general understanding becuase for instance some candidates seemed smart but one of them had more information about game design, now thats great and they might be smart but thats not what our company does, I wouldnt be keen on interviewing this candidate because its not what they would be interested in doing and wouldnt say that long and got a lower ranking then others. In addition, some candidates had WAY to much information on the page and seemed like they wouldn't be a good fit in anything but super niche positions one person was listing space on everything - if they want to work for NASA thats great, but not a very diverse resume I wouldn't consider this candidate for any role - similar reasons for the game designer. The survey should be asking questions based on a position posting you provide for recruiters to understand what position they are applying to - not positions at my spesific company - also because you had me put in my company information - I felt like I was unable to answer DEI questions honestly because I do not know if this data truly stays just for this class or will be publish therefore I have to forfit answering company questions like pay and DEI
35. "pursue or not pursue" question was confusing
36. Most start ups are not going to hire new grads unless they have extensive lab (BAIR)experience and really good internships. Even then, there will be a push for more experience from hiring managers unless someone has technically demonstrated their prowess in the interview process or with side companies/projects/github repositories.
37. Maybe ask me what types of Engineers I hire for and figure out how to have me review those types of engineers. Otherwise I am reviewing engineers who skills just don't line up from the beginning
38. Consider accessibility. I have low vision and noticed when I tried to zoom on the resumes - only the survey part tothe right with the questions would enlarge but the resumes would not - that made it difficult and time-consuming to struggle to read.
39. Include more senior resumes to gauge technical fit
40. Allow me to try out the coding questions or provide a link to a repo with the test cases
41. I really liked it. Maybe too many questions on DEI specifically, but I understand that's part of the research. Also hard for me to answer on some of the current company policies and even ethnic makeup, but I was able to provide a rough estimate. Many candidates seemed like good potential fits, even some with a score <90 could be successful, individual drive matters more than if the sample code compiles. I didn't look at the resume's that closely, because a lot of the details do not matter on a technical level, like GPA or where exactly they worked, just filtering for candidates with direct experience versus more tangential, like in AI research or AWS, which is still useful, but less so than general Python development, curiosity, and work ethic.
42. Not really, but I feel bad that none of the candidates fit what we're looking for.
43. Chill out on all the DEI questions at the end.
44. I wish I could also provide an explanation/justification when scoring the candidates.
45. A question related to Overall Rating for a candidate should include reference to overall candidate rating based on general industry standards OR overall candidate rating in regards to a specific organization's overall skill hiring pattern.

46. increase the contrast for easier resume review
47. This is a great survey.
48. The question on how do you predict the person will stay with a company is not something recruiters evaluate based on resume.
49. being able to go back so I can remember what I scored the other resumes would be helpful, to make sure I'm sticking to the same scale
50. I'll preface with the fact that I basically only do technical assessment interviews, so perhaps resumes are important in other interview types. But for me, I'm really only paying attention to how well the candidate understands the exercise and how they perform at it (both in terms of code and behaviorally). I never read candidate resumes, so I just had to guess on the question asking about the last candidate's resume. A candidate's great resume won't overshadow poor technical assessment performance and I feel like looking at the resume can really only introduce bias into the decision making. Here are the questions I ask myself during and after an interview: Did the candidate fully understand the exercise? Did they ask clarifying questions to understand it? Did the candidate ask about edge cases? Did the candidate explain their approach before going into it? Is the candidate aware of trade offs they're making with their approach? How well does the candidate explain their thought process during the exercise? Bonus points if it's not prompted. How well does the candidate receive feedback or ideas? Was the candidate able to debug problems by themselves? If not or if they're still stuck, how receptive are they to help? Did the candidate write tests? Is this someone I wouldn't mind working with on the same team? Is this someone I would vouch for? Because they're likely not joining my team
51. It's strange to have to score candidates on a 0-100 system when that's not at all how we think about hiring. The resume review plays a very minor role, basically we only look for: 1) school is reputable, 2) candidate has shown at least one example of taking initiative to learn (project, or previous internship experience). After that, it's easy to send a coderpad and only continue with candidates that pass it. Our coding questions are not these weird LeetCode questions that test knowledge irrelevant to the job. Many startups no longer ask those questions. Even Stripe, my previous employer, doesn't ask those questions. I scored some candidates highly for commenting their code with their thought process over implementing a 100% correct solution. In our actual interview, we don't care about passing all test cases if you demonstrated thinking through the problem logically.
52. What's the chance of getting professionals to spend an hour answering so many questions with only \$40?
53. This took much longer than 15 minutes so I would start by being honest with participants. I think it might be better if there was more than just a ranking. Understanding why I answered a certain way would probably add value.
54. The degree is a BA in all resume almost, in tech field the BS degree is preferred compare to BA degree for coding...
55. I think I could have provided a more well-rounded perspective with more varied free text questions. The DEI questions are a good example of what I mean, but were rather single-minded. I could have rambled about AI for a bit, but maybe that's not what you're trying to capture in this research. It's probably hard to balance free text questions with a bunch of people trying to speed through a survey for their gift card!
56. It's a bit long to do.
57. It would be helpful to understand your intent so I could have answered more thoroughly.
58. Coding is a very broad term, it is hard to measure on a scale without knowing if scripting is considered coding for the purpose of the survey
59. I have some feedback regarding the structure of the three questions asked after reviewing the 18 resumes and coding samples. First, regarding the question on coding ability, the 1-10 scale feels too subjective and granular. It is perceptually difficult to distinguish the specific difference between a 1 and a 2, or a 6 and a 7. This ambiguity likely adds noise to your data. A decision based scale would be more effective for this type of review. Suggested Alternative: "Based on the code sample, does this candidate possess the technical baseline required for the role?" (Options: Yes / No / Borderline) Second, regarding the question on company fit, the context was ambiguous. It was unclear whether I should be evaluating the individual as a prospective candidate entering the pipeline or as someone who was already hired and working within the team. Clarifying the stage of the funnel would improve the quality of the answers. Suggested Alternative: "Based on this resume, would you invite this candidate for an initial behavioral phone screen?" Third, the question asking if the candidate would last 5 years is problematic. It is nearly impossible to extrapolate retention that far into the future. Employee turnover is often driven by life events, management changes,

or market conditions rather than the candidate's inherent quality or performance. It would be more useful to evaluate their trajectory or growth potential. Suggested Alternative: "Does this candidate demonstrate the potential to grow into a senior or leadership role within the organization?" Finally, I suggest adding a question at the end of the survey asking the reviewer what they felt candidates were missing in their resumes or coding samples. This would allow for actionable feedback that could be shared with the students to help them improve. To demonstrate the value of this question, here is the specific feedback I would have provided regarding the 18 candidates I reviewed: 1, Open Source Contributions: Some candidates lacked work experience, and open source contributions are the best substitute for this. Contributing to open source exposes students to real world workflows such as CI/CD, bug fixing, release schedules, and cross team collaboration. Furthermore, it significantly improves technical skills by exposing students to complex, real world code and architectures that are rarely seen in school projects. It prepares them for the job more effectively than personal projects. I would advise students to avoid overwhelming projects like Kubernetes or Linux and instead pick active, well maintained projects that they enjoy using. 2. Code Quality vs. Solution Correctness: This was the biggest gap I observed across the samples. While some candidates found the correct answers, their code often lacked professional polish. I understand that candidates are under a time crunch, but they should still make an effort to write clean code. If students practice writing good code consistently, they will naturally get faster at it. Eventually, even their code written under time constraints will be respectable and maintainable. It might not be perfect, but it will be a major improvement over using single letter variables like "i" or "j" and lacking comments. The goal should be to write plain, simple code that a colleague can easily understand.

- 60. I think it's important to challenge tech hirers with questions about racial and gender bias in their hiring practices. Add more DEI questions, ask them if they're racist.
- 61. I find the question of a candidate's projected tenure to be of limited value. It's inherently difficult to predict based on a resume and code samples, as it depends heavily on external factors and future circumstances.
- 62. took more than 15 minutes.
- 63. It was really long. I would shorten it.
- 64. If you had provided a free-form input along with each resume, I could describe *why* I rated each candidate the way I did.
- 65. Some of the responses to the technical questions were stated to have solved all of the test cases, but appear to be incorrect. For example, one example I saw from the cookie question assumed that the input lists were sorted and therefore did not sort them, but if the lists weren't sorted then it would have been incorrect.

->